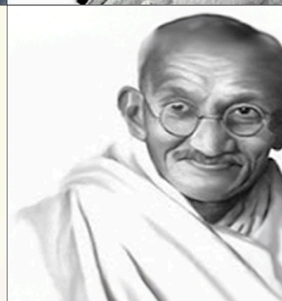
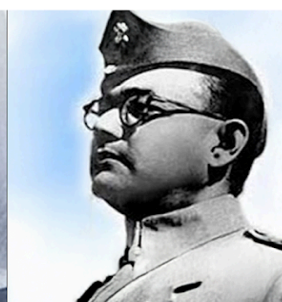


General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

Freedom Movement (1919-1929)

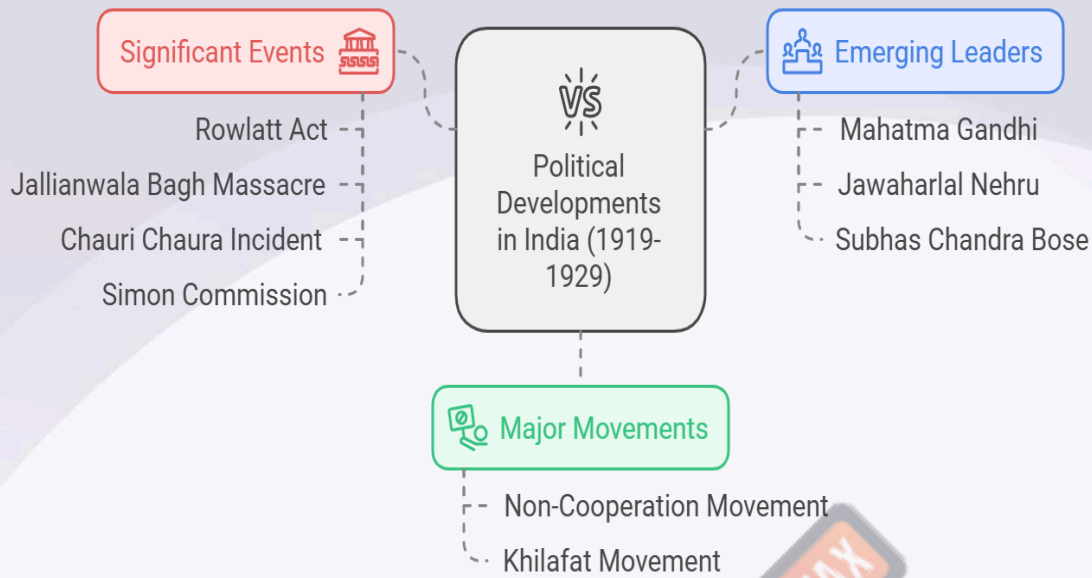


Freedom Movement (1919 - 1929)

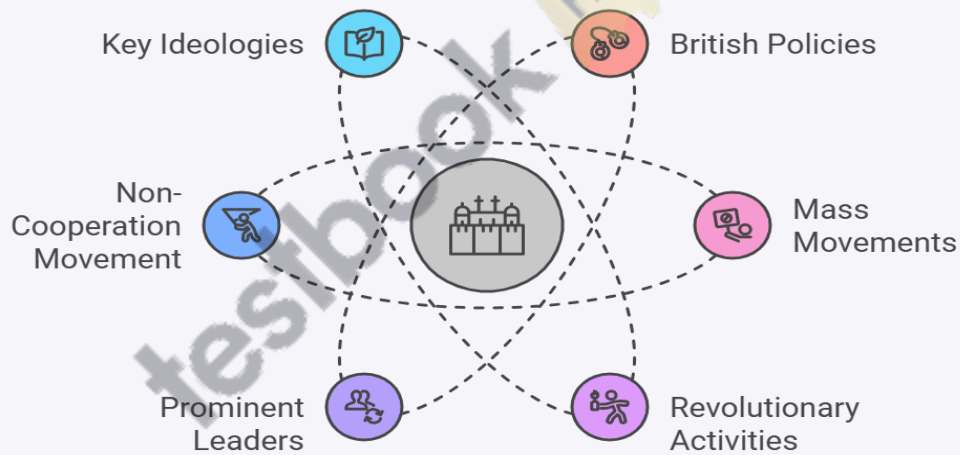


Introduction

- The decade from **1919 to 1929** was pivotal in India's struggle for independence.
- During this period, political consciousness spread rapidly across India, and the Indian populace, led by influential leaders, intensified their demand for self-rule.
- The oppressive policies of the British government and their disregard for Indian voices fueled several movements, from peaceful protests to revolutionary activities.
 - This era saw the rise of Mahatma Gandhi's leadership, the emergence of Hindu-Muslim unity through the Mahatma Gandhi's leadership, the launch of the Non-Cooperation Movement, and the formation of new ideologies advocating for complete independence.



Dynamics of India's Freedom Movement



Major Events and Developments:

Year	Event	Key Details	Outcome / Impact
1919	Rowlatt Act	Authorized detention without trial	Protests and outrage across India

1919	Jallianwala Bagh Massacre	Massacre of civilians in Amritsar	Strengthened anti-British sentiment
1919-1924	Khilafat Movement	Support for the Ottoman Caliphate	Decline after the Caliphate abolished
1920-1922	Non-Cooperation Movement	Mass non-violent protest led by Gandhi	Called off after the Chauri Chaura incident
1922	Chauri Chaura Incident	Violent clashes, killing of policemen	Non-Cooperation Movement called off
1923	Swaraj Party Formation	Faction to contest British Council elections	Highlighted ideological differences in Congress
1927	Simon Commission	British-only committee to review the constitution	Nationwide protests; "Simon, go back!"
1928	Nehru Report	Drafted Dominion Status Constitution	Rejected by younger leaders
1929	Lahore Session of Congress	Purna Swaraj Declaration	a marked shift towards complete independence

Rowlatt Act (1919)

- **Background:** In 1919, the British government enacted the **Rowlatt Act**, officially known as the **Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act**. The Act aimed to extend wartime restrictions into peacetime, specifically targeting revolutionary activities.
- **Provisions:** It allowed the British government to imprison any Indian without trial and restrict their freedoms, including the press and public assembly.
- **Response:** Indian leaders, including Mahatma Gandhi, condemned the Act, calling it unjust. It led to widespread protests and strikes across the nation.

- **Significance:** This Act catalyzed Indian discontent with British rule and set the stage for future resistance.

Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (1919)

- **Incident:** On **April 13, 1919**, people gathered at **Jallianwala Bagh** in **Amritsar** to protest the **Rowlatt Act** peacefully. General Dyer, a British officer, ordered his troops to fire on the unarmed crowd.
- **Casualties:** Official British reports noted about 379 deaths and over 1,000 injuries, though Indian sources suggest much higher figures.
- **Impact:** This massacre shocked the nation and led to international condemnation of British actions. It intensified Indian anger and strengthened calls for independence.

Khilafat Movement (1919-1924)

- **Background:** The movement arose to protect the Ottoman Caliphate, considered a symbolic leader for Muslims worldwide. After World War I, the British dismantled the Caliphate, inciting widespread anger.
- **Objective:** Led by the Ali Brothers (Shaukat Ali and Mohammad Ali), the Khilafat Movement aimed to restore the Caliphate and demanded British respect for Muslim religious authority.
- **Alliances:** Due to Gandhiji's efforts, this movement merged with the non-cooperation movement. Gandhiji's idea behind this was to create a powerful Hindu-Muslim unity.
- **Decline:** The movement waned by **1924** when Mustafa Kemal Atatürk abolished the Ottoman Caliphate, marking the end of its relevance.

Non-Cooperation Movement (1920-1922)

- **Leader:** Spearheaded by Mahatma Gandhi, this was one of the first large-scale movements he led.
- **Aim:** To achieve **Swaraj**, or self-rule, through peaceful non-cooperation with the British.
- **Methods:**
 - Boycott of British goods, government schools, courts, and positions.
 - Promotion of Khadi (Indian-made cloth) as a symbol of resistance.
 - Resignation of titles and honors given by the British.
- **Outcome:** The movement mobilized millions but was eventually called off by Gandhi in 1922 following the violent Chauri Chaura incident.

Chauri Chaura Incident (1922)

- **Date:** February 4, 1922.
- **Incident:** A protest in **Chauri Chaura**, Uttar Pradesh, escalated into a violent clash between protesters and police, leading to the burning of a police station and the death of 22 policemen.
- **Impact:** Gandhi called off the **Non-Cooperation Movement**, emphasizing his commitment to non-violence (ahimsa).
- **Significance:** This incident marked a turning point, causing the movement to lose momentum but underscoring Gandhi's principle of non-violence in future freedom struggles.

Swaraj Party Formation (1923)

- **Leaders:** Prominent Congress leaders Motilal Nehru and Chittaranjan Das.
- **Objective:** After the Non-Cooperation Movement ended, some Congress leaders wanted to contest elections in the legislative councils to push for reforms from within the government.
- **Significance:** This split in Congress highlighted differing approaches to freedom: **non-cooperation** (led by Gandhi) vs. **legislative participation** (led by the Swaraj Party).
- **Outcome:** The Swaraj Party won significant seats in legislative councils but was limited by British control.

Simon Commission (1927)

- **Purpose:** Established by the British government, the Simon Commission was tasked with reviewing the Indian constitutional framework and suggesting reforms.
- The Commission consisted solely of British members, leading Indians to feel that their voices were being ignored.
- **"Simon, go back!"** became the rallying cry as protests erupted across the country.
- **Lala Lajpat Rai**, a prominent leader, suffered fatal injuries during a protest against the Commission, which fueled further resentment against British rule.

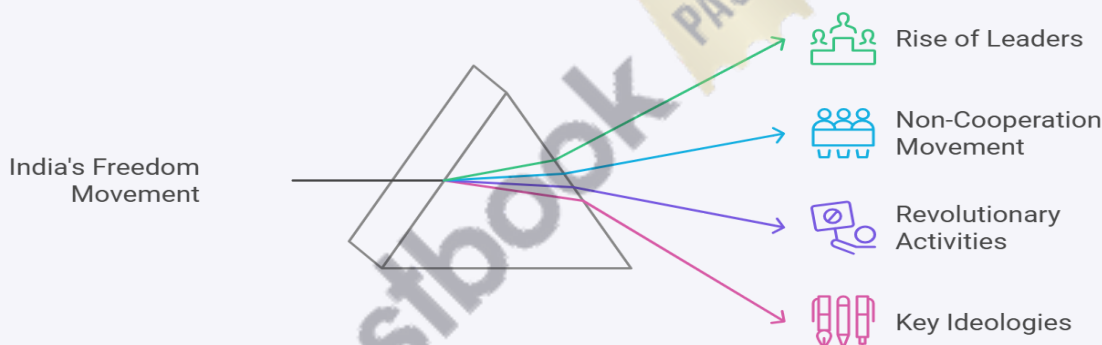
Nehru Report (1928)

- **Background:** Indian leaders demanded **Dominion Status**, with self-governing rights like other British colonies.

- Draft: Motilal Nehru, chairman of the report, proposed a **federal structure for India**, **fundamental rights**, and a **parliamentary system**.
- Younger leaders like **Jawaharlal Nehru** and **Subhas Chandra Bose** opposed the report, arguing for **complete independence** instead of **Dominion Status**.
- The report sparked a divide between moderates and radicals within Congress and set the stage for the demand for **Purna Swaraj**.

Lahore Session of Congress (1929)

- **President: Jawaharlal Nehru.**
- Resolution: The Congress passed the historic “Purna Swaraj” (complete independence) resolution, rejecting Dominion Status.
- **January 26, 1930**, was declared the first “**Independence Day**” and celebrated nationwide.
- This session marked a shift towards complete independence, signaling the start of the **Civil Disobedience Movement** in **1930**.



Significance of the Decade (1919-1929)

Emergence of Mass Movements

- The Non-Cooperation Movement marked the first time that Indians from all walks of life participated in the struggle for freedom.
- This decade saw ordinary citizens, including farmers, students, and women, joining the independence movement in large numbers.

Ideological Shifts

- As the freedom movement evolved, so did its objectives. Initially, leaders demanded reforms and autonomy within the British Empire.
- By the end of the 1920s, however, complete independence had become the goal, driven by leaders like Jawaharlal Nehru and Subhas Chandra Bose.

Gandhi's Leadership and Non-Violence

- This period established Gandhi as the leader of the freedom movement and popularized non-violence (ahimsa) as a guiding principle.
- Gandhi's methods of peaceful resistance became a defining feature of India's struggle for independence.

Unity Among Indians

- The decade witnessed unprecedented Hindu-Muslim unity, especially during the Khilafat and Non-Cooperation movements.
- Although this unity faced challenges later, it demonstrated the possibility of communal harmony in the fight against British rule.

Foundations of Revolutionaries

- The Simon Commission protests and the death of Lala Lajpat Rai inspired young revolutionaries like Bhagat Singh, who became influential figures in the fight for independence.
- This decade saw the emergence of organizations like the HSRA, which used revolutionary methods to challenge British authority.

Towards Complete Independence

- By the end of this period, the demand for "Purna Swaraj" became the rallying cry for the Indian National Congress.
- The Lahore Session of 1929 set the course for the Civil Disobedience Movement, which would play a critical role in the next phase of the freedom struggle.
- the period from 1919 to 1929 was marked by the transformation of India's freedom movement from moderate reform demands to a full-fledged fight for independence.
- The events of this decade laid a strong foundation for subsequent movements and mobilized the entire nation toward the goal of complete self-rule.